exploitation by non-tribals are assured. In any case, the Shanti Bahini's activities have a limited tribal appeal and would be of little importance on the national scene. The scope of their activities and their capabilities also are limited and can be contained by the troops available in the region, where 65 Brigade, based in Chittagong, has always been committed for dealing with the Chakma insurgents.

The Indians knew that Sheikh Mujib's Awami League had gone defunct as a political force immediately after the coup as many surviving leaders jumped ship in their need to be seen as supporters of the new regime. The Awami League had also been considerably discredited in the later years of Sheikh Mujib's regime because most of its prominent leaders had a reputation for corruption and nepotism. The euphoria of liberation had lasted just about a year; over the next three years there had been growing disenchantment with the party among the almost 85 per cent Muslim majority. Only Sheikh Mujib's personality and charisma as the father of the nation had prevented this disenchantment from growing to unimaginable proportions in his lifetime. While the intelligentsia probably missed the feeling of stability that Sheikh Mujib's regime provided, it had also been disenchanted with his government's activities. This was equally true for the bureaucracy. The best among the bureaucrats had been frustrated and humiliated by continuous interference from the political supporters of the Sheikh and what they considered the prime minister's lack of confidence in them. The economic degeneration during the Sheikh's regime with spiralling inflation, corruption, inefficiency in the distribution of relief materials and lack of any real effort by the regime to mitigate the hardships of the masses, had also left the country's labour and peasantry disillusioned by Mujib, the Awami League and what they stood for.